Name: _____ **Period:** _____ **Date:** _____

Topic 4.6 Guided Notes: Motivation

Unit 4: Social Psychology and Personality | AP Psychology

Directions: Read through the topic overview page below and fill in each blank as you go. Use the tables and activities to check your understanding, then head to the quiz link at the end to test yourself.

Source page: appsychreviewhub.com/overviews/topic4.6

Word Bank

Instincts	*Self-Determination Theory*	*Extrinsic Motivation*
Intrinsic Motivation	*Yerkes-Dodson Law*	*Incentive Theory*
Drive-Reduction Theory	*Arousal Theory*	*Homeostasis*
Instinct Theory	*Motivation*	

1. Biological and Arousal Theories of Motivation

We are now transitioning from exploring who we are (personality) to exploring why we do what we do. _____ focuses on the varied reasons behind our behaviors and mental processes. Because human behavior is so complex, psychologists have developed several different theories to explain what exactly pushes us into action.

Some of the most fundamental theories of motivation focus on our biology, physical needs, and desires:

- _____: Because it is deeply rooted in biology, this is often the starting point for understanding motivation. _____ are innate, typically fixed patterns of behavior in response to certain stimuli. While many non-human animals are strongly motivated by them, humans actually demonstrate very few rigid behaviors of this kind.
- _____: When a biological need (like hunger or thirst) arises, it creates an uncomfortable internal state or "drive." We are then motivated to act in a way that reduces that drive and restores _____, the body's natural tendency to maintain a steady, balanced internal state—much like a thermostat regulating the temperature in a house.
- _____: Once our basic biological needs are met and homeostasis is achieved, we then feel driven to seek stimulation. This theory addresses how people are motivated to seek an optimal level of arousal rather than just physical balance. A key component of this is the _____, which demonstrates that performance increases with arousal up to an optimal point, after which too much arousal (like extreme anxiety) will decrease performance.

Graph note: The performance curve is an inverted U. As arousal rises from a low state, performance steadily improves because of increasing attention and interest. At the peak is the "sweet spot," the optimal level of arousal for maximum performance. If arousal keeps climbing past that peak into the high zone, it turns into strong anxiety, and performance drops right back down.

Apply It: Which Biological or Arousal Idea?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	Newly hatched sea turtles, with no teaching at all, crawl straight toward the ocean.	
2	After a sleepless night, a student feels a powerful need for rest, takes a nap, and feels back to normal.	
3	When she gets too cold, a woman's body starts shivering to warm up, then stops once her body temperature returns to normal.	
4	Bored after a quiet weekend alone, a teen texts friends to go to a trampoline park.	
5	A pianist plays best when she feels moderately energized before a recital, but she plays worse if she is half-asleep or if her nerves become overwhelming.	

2. Intrinsic vs. Extrinsic Motivation

Beyond basic survival, we are motivated by our goals and our environment. _____ proposes that people are motivated by either internal or external forces.

- _____: Doing something because you find it personally rewarding or inherently interesting.
- _____: Doing something to earn a reward or avoid a punishment. Closely related to this is _____, which specifically explores the role of external rewards in motivating behavior.

Apply It: Intrinsic, Extrinsic, or Incentive?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	A girl spends hours drawing comics in her notebook simply because she loves it, though no one will ever grade or pay her for them.	
2	A teen cleans his room only to avoid being grounded this weekend.	
3	A grocery store hands out coupons and prize drawings to draw in shoppers, banking on how powerfully external rewards motivate people.	

Word Bank

Sensation-Seeking Theory	*Leptin*	*Pituitary Gland*
Boredom Susceptibility	*Disinhibition*	*Lewin's Motivational Conflicts Theory*
Approach-Approach	*Experience Seeking*	*Hypothalamus*
Ghrelin	*Thrill and Adventure Seeking*	*Approach-Avoidance*
Belongingness	*Avoidance-Avoidance*	

3. Sensation-Seeking Theory

Because humans aren't entirely bound by simple instincts and basic drive reduction, we are often motivated by the need for novel, varied, and complex experiences. _____ proposes that an individual's natural drive for these unique experiences is a fundamental motivator. Psychologist Marvin Zuckerman identified four distinct types:

- _____: The desire to engage in physically risky or exciting activities. (e.g., Skydiving, bungee jumping, or extreme mountain biking.)
- _____: The pursuit of new sensations through the mind, senses, and non-conforming lifestyles. (e.g., Backpacking through a foreign country with no itinerary, trying exotic foods, or exploring unconventional art and music.)
- _____: The drive to seek sensation through social activities, partying, and lowering typical social restraints. (e.g., Engaging in wild, impulsive social behaviors, heavy drinking, or acting recklessly at a loud party.)
- _____: An extreme intolerance for routine, repetitive activities, or predictable people. (e.g., Feeling incredibly restless when a class lecture goes on too long, or frequently switching jobs because the daily routine becomes unbearable.)

Apply It: Which Type of Sensation Seeking?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	A teenager signs up for white-water rafting down the roughest rapids and says she wants to try cliff diving next.	
2	A woman learns to play a rare folk instrument, joins an experimental theater group, and eats at a different unfamiliar restaurant every week.	
3	At a party, a man takes every dare, ignores his usual social rules, and acts far wilder than he ever would at work.	
4	A student feels almost physically uncomfortable when a teacher uses the same review-sheet format week after week, and she tunes out within minutes.	

4. Lewin's Motivational Conflicts Theory

Sometimes, our motivation is paralyzed by having to make a choice. _____ proposes that choices create psychological conflicts that one must resolve, forming the basis of motivation. You need to know these three types of conflicts:

- _____: Choosing between two highly desirable options. (e.g., Choosing between going to the beach or going to an amusement park.)
- _____: Choosing between two highly undesirable options. (e.g., Choosing between doing chores or doing homework.)
- _____: Facing a single choice that has both positive and negative consequences. (e.g., Being offered a great new job that requires moving away from all your friends.)

Apply It: Which Motivational Conflict?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	A student has been accepted to two colleges she loves and must pick just one.	
2	A boy must either confess that he broke a window or let his friend take the blame, and he dreads both options.	
3	A man is invited to try a thrilling roller coaster he has always wanted to ride, but he is terrified of heights.	

5. Specific Motivators: Eating and Belongingness

Eating is a complex motivated behavior that perfectly demonstrates how physical and mental processes interact. It isn't just about an empty stomach!

- Biological Factors: Hormones such as _____ (the hunger signal) and _____ (the fullness signal) regulate our appetite. These hormones are closely monitored and regulated by the _____ via the _____.
- Environmental/External Factors: The behavior of eating is also heavily influenced by external cues like the mere presence of food, the time of day, or social gatherings centered around meals.

Beyond physical needs like eating, humans are also motivated by social needs. _____ refers to the fundamental human drive to form and maintain close, meaningful connections with others. This need can shape behavior just as powerfully as physical drives—people will often go out of their way to seek acceptance, avoid rejection, or maintain relationships, even when doing so requires real effort or sacrifice.

Apply It: Which Eating or Social Motivator?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	After a big dinner, a hormone signals to a woman's brain that she is full, and she pushes her plate away.	

#	Scenario	Concept
2	A small brain region monitors a man's blood chemistry and helps regulate the hormones that control his appetite.	
3	A pea-sized gland at the base of the brain helps relay the signals that regulate a woman's hunger hormones.	
4	A new student sits alone at lunch, longs for friends, and works hard to join a club so that she can feel accepted.	

📺 *Video Notes: "The Power of Motivation" (Crash Course Psychology #17)*

This video covers more than today's topic. Maslow's hierarchy of needs (about 4:49 to 5:29) and sex motivation (about 5:29 to 6:32) are outside the scope of the AP Exam, so you can skip those parts. Watch the video above, then answer the questions below on the parts that match today's material.

1. How does the video describe instinct theory, why does it say the original idea was misguided, and how are instincts defined today?

2. How does the video explain drive-reduction theory, including homeostasis and incentives, and what limitation does it point out?

3. What does the video's theory of optimal arousal say, and what examples does it give?

4. How does the video describe the biology of hunger, and what shapes what we are hungry for?

5. What was the Minnesota Hunger Experiment, and what effects of starvation did it find?

6. According to the video, why does belonging matter, how is it balanced with autonomy, and what evidence does it give?

6. Don't Trip Up! (Common Misconceptions)

⚠️ Drive-Reduction vs. Arousal Theory: Students often confuse these two biological theories. Remember that _____ is about reaching a neutral, balanced state of homeostasis (getting rid of an uncomfortable urge). _____ is about seeking stimulation (riding a roller coaster because you are bored). They pull you in opposite directions!

7. Quick Check: Review Questions

Circle the best answer for each question below.

1. After drinking a full glass of water, the hiker's uncomfortable feeling of thirst completely disappears, and his body returns to a steady, balanced internal state once again. This natural tendency of the body to maintain a steady, balanced internal state is called:

- **A.** Homeostasis
- **B.** Arousal
- **C.** Incentive Theory
- **D.** Instinct

2. During an extremely high-stakes championship game, a normally excellent athlete becomes so overwhelmed with intense anxiety and nervous tension that his performance suffers dramatically and he makes several uncharacteristic mistakes. According to the Yerkes-Dodson Law, this athlete's performance drop is best explained by:

- **A.** A complete lack of any intrinsic motivation to perform well in the game
- **B.** The instinct theory of motivation being the sole cause of this specific performance drop
- **C.** His arousal level climbing past the optimal peak into a zone of excessive anxiety
- **D.** His arousal level being far too low for the demands of the situation

3. A salesperson works incredibly hard to close a major deal specifically because his company has promised him a substantial cash bonus and a company-wide recognition award for hitting his sales target. This type of motivation, driven by earning an external reward, is called:

- **A.** Extrinsic Motivation
- **B.** Self-Determination Theory Exclusively
- **C.** Intrinsic Motivation
- **D.** Arousal Theory

4. A man regularly seeks out physically risky and exciting activities like skydiving, bungee jumping, and extreme mountain biking, specifically craving the intense adrenaline rush that comes with genuine physical danger. According to Zuckerman's sensation-seeking theory, this specific type of sensation seeking is called:

- **A.** Experience Seeking
- **B.** Disinhibition
- **C.** Boredom Susceptibility
- **D.** Thrill and Adventure Seeking

5. A woman feels an overwhelming and nearly unbearable sense of restlessness whenever a work meeting drags on too long or a lecture becomes repetitive, and she frequently switches jobs simply because the daily routine eventually becomes intolerable to her. According to Zuckerman's sensation-seeking theory, this specific type of sensation seeking is called:

- **A.** Disinhibition
- **B.** Thrill and Adventure Seeking
- **C.** Boredom Susceptibility
- **D.** Experience Seeking

6. A woman is offered an exciting dream job with a substantial salary increase, but accepting the position would require her to relocate across the country, far away from all of her close friends and family. According to Lewin's motivational conflicts theory, this type of conflict, involving a single choice with both positive and negative consequences, is called:

- **A.** Avoidance-Avoidance Conflict
- **B.** Reciprocal Determinism
- **C.** Approach-Avoidance Conflict
- **D.** Approach-Approach Conflict

7. A hormone that stimulates hunger increases significantly when a person's stomach is empty, signaling to the brain that it is time to eat. This specific hunger-stimulating hormone, closely monitored by the hypothalamus, is called:

- **A.** Leptin
- **B.** Oxytocin
- **C.** Melatonin
- **D.** Ghrelin

✅ Check Your Progress

Done with your notes? Head over to the Quiz to test what you've learned:
https://appsychreviewhub.com/quiz

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